in lieu of the permanent means of access.
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Table 2 - Means of access for bulk carriers*

1 Cargo holds 2 Ballast tanks

Access to overhead structure
1.1 At least 3 permanent means of access shall be fitted to provide access to the overhead structure at both sides of the cross deck and in the vicinity of the centreline. Each means of access shall be accessible from the cargo hold access or directly from the main deck and installed at a minimum of 1.8 m to a maximum of 2.5 m below the deck.

1.2 Alternatively, movable means of access may be utilized for access to the overhead structure of cross deck if its vertical distance is 17 m or less above the tank top.

Top side tanks
2.1 For each topside tank of which the height is 6 m and over, one longitudinal continuous permanent

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SOURCE: MSC.133(76).pdf
be utilized for access to the overhead structure of cross deck if its vertical distance is 17 m or less above the tank top.

Top side tanks
2.1 For each topside tank of which the height is 6 m and over, one longitudinal continuous permanent
means of access shall be provided along the side shell webs and installed at a minimum of 1.8 m to a maximum of 2.5 m below deck with a vertical access ladder in the vicinity of each access to that tank.

2.2 If no access holes are provided through the transverse ring webs within 600 mm of the tank base and the web frame rings have a web height greater than 1 m in way of side shell and sloping plating, then step rungs/grab rails shall be provided to allow safe access over each transverse web frame ring.

2.3 Three permanent means of access, fitted at the end bay and middle bay of each tank, shall be provided spanning from tank base up to the intersection of the sloping plate with the hatch side girder. The existing longitudinal structure may be used as part of this means of access.

2.4 For topside tanks of which the height is less than 6 m, a portable means may be utilized in lieu of the

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SOURCE: MSC.133(76).pdf
sloping plate with the hatch side girder. The existing longitudinal structure may be used as part of this means of access.

2.4 For topside tanks of which the height is less than 6 m, a portable means may be utilized in lieu of the
permanent means of access.
Access to vertical structures

1.3 Permanent means of vertical access shall be provided in all cargo holds and built into the structure to allow for an inspection of a minimum of 25 % of the total number of hold frames port and starboard equally distributed throughout the hold including at each end in way of transverse bulkheads. But in no circumstance shall this arrangement be less than 3 permanent means of vertical access fitted to each side (fore and aft ends of hold and mid-span). Means to readily secure safety cages to the permanent means of access shall be provided. Permanent means of vertical access fitted between two adjacent hold frames is counted for an access for the inspection of both hold frames. A means of portable access may be used to gain access over the sloping plating of lower hopper ballast tanks.

1.4 In addition, portable or movable means of

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SOURCE: MSC.133(76).pdf
access for the inspection of both hold frames. A means of portable access may be used to gain access over the sloping plating of lower hopper ballast tanks.

1.4 In addition, portable or movable means of
access shall be utilized for access to the remaining hold frames up to their upper brackets and transverse bulkheads.
Bilge hopper tanks

2.5 For each bilge hopper tank of which the height is 6 m and over, one longitudinal continuous permanent means of access shall be provided along the side shell webs and installed at a minimum of 1.2 m to a maximum of 1.8 m below the top of the clear opening of the web ring with a vertical access ladder in the vicinity of each access to the tank.

2.6 If no access holes are provided through the transverse ring webs within 600 mm of the tank base and the web frame rings have a web height greater than 1 m in way of side shell and sloping plating, then step rungs/grab rails shall be provided to allow safe access over each transverse web frame ring.

2.7 For bilge hopper tanks of which the height is less than 6 m, a portable means may be utilized in lieu of the permanent means of access.

Double skin side tanks

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SOURCE: MSC.133(76).pdf
over each transverse web frame ring.

2.7 For bilge hopper tanks of which the height is less than 6 m, a portable means may be utilized in lieu of the permanent means of access.

Double skin side tanks

2.8 Permanent means of access shall be provided in accordance with the applicable sections of table 1.
* For ore carriers, permanent means of access in wing ba llast tanks shall be provi ded in accordance with the applicable sections of table 1.

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ANNEX 3

RESOLUTION MSC.134(76)
(adopted on 12 December 2002)

ADOPTION OF AMENDMENTS TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION
FOR THE SAFETY OF LIFE AT SEA, 1974, AS AMENDED

THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE,

RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee,

RECALLING FURTHER article VIII(b) of the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS), 1974 (hereinafter referre d to as "the Convention"), concerning the amendment procedure applicable to the Annex to the Convention, other than to the provisions of chapter I thereof,